

UNIT 4 SOFTWARE



Learning Objectives

- Define software and understand its role in performing tasks on a computer.
- Identify and differentiate between system software (e.g., operating systems, device drivers) and application software (e.g., Paint, Word).
- Understand device drivers and their role in using new hardware.
- Practise using application software through hands-on activities.



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SOFTWARE

Software is a set of instructions given to a computer to perform a specific task. The games we play and the programs we run on a computer are examples of software.

There are two **types of software**:

1. System Software
2. Application Software



SYSTEM SOFTWARE

System software is designed to operate the hardware and provide an environment for running other software. It includes device drivers, utilities, and an operating system.

MS Windows is an example of an operating system. It is the most commonly used system software.

Some versions of Windows are:

- Windows XP
- Windows 7
- Windows 10
- Windows 11



Windows XP



Windows 7

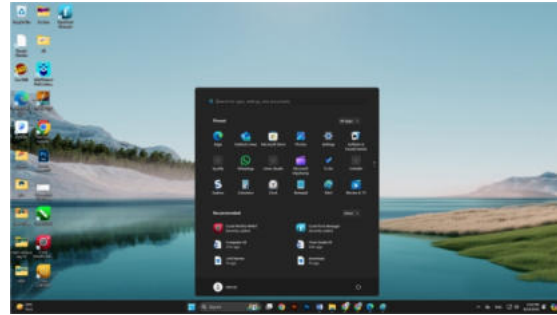


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Windows 10



Windows 11

When we buy a new computer part, it comes with its own software, which helps the operating system communicate with and use the new part. This software is called a **device driver**.

For example:

The device driver for a printer tells the computer how to communicate and operate the printer.



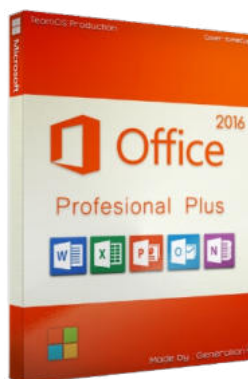
APPLICATION SOFTWARE

Application software is designed for the user of the computer, also called the end user. These programs help users perform specific tasks such as creating documents, editing images, or browsing the internet.

Application software includes programs like Paint, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Media Players, and Internet Browsers.



CorelDRAW



MS Office



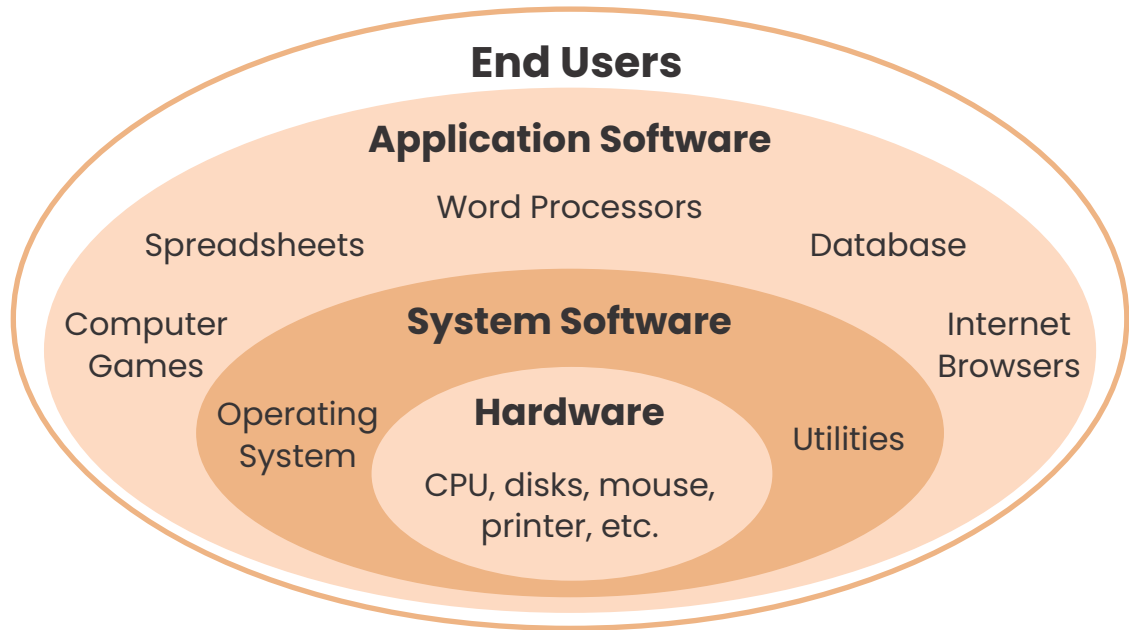
WinDVD Pro12



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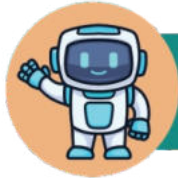
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We can understand the components of a computer with the following diagram:



Hardware and **software** work together and cannot be used alone.





EXERCISE 1



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Circle the correct answer.

1. What does a device driver do?

A

Plays games on the computer

B

Helps the OS communicate with hardware

C

manages internet connections

D

runs spreadsheets

2. Which of these is NOT application software?

A

MS Word

B

Windows XP

C

Excel

D

PowerPoint

3. Why do end users need application software?

A

To run system drivers

B

To perform specific tasks like writing documents or creating images

C

To install the operating system

D

To control CPU performance

4. If a computer has no operating system installed, what will happen when you turn it on?

A

The computer will show an error or fail to start

B

It will automatically run Paint

C

It will load application software

D

collectively

5. Which software category does 'Word Processor' belong to?

A

System Software

B

Application Software

C

Utilities

D

Device Drivers



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6. A user needs to browse the internet and write reports. What software will they use?

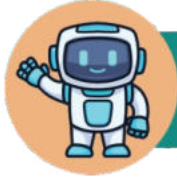
- A** Device driver and utilities
- B** System software and application software
- C** Only operating system
- D** CPU software

7. You installed a new version of system software. What is its impact?

- A** Improves communication between hardware and software
- B** Deletes all files in the system
- C** Makes the computer slower
- D** Stops application software from running

8. What happens if there is no device driver for new hardware?

- A** The hardware will not work properly
- B** The system software will automatically fix it
- C** Application software will install the required drivers
- D** The computer will shut down permanently



EXERCISE 2



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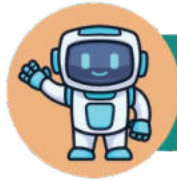
Fill in the blanks.

1. System software includes device drivers, utilities, and an _____.
2. _____ is the most commonly used system software.
3. End user means the _____ of the computer.
4. Hardware and _____ work with each other.
5. Application software includes _____, Internet browsers, etc.
6. Application software is designed for the _____.



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EXERCISE 3

Mark "True" or "False".

TRUE

FALSE

System software includes the operating system and device drivers.

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Application software is used for performing general-purpose tasks.

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MS Windows is an example of application software.

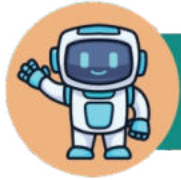
☐☐

Hardware and software cannot work independently.

☐☐

Device drivers help computers communicate with external hardware.

☐☐



EXERCISE 1



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Answer the following questions.

1. What is software? Name different types of software.

Ans: _____

2. What is system software?

Ans: _____

3. What is application software?

Ans: _____

4. Can you name some system software and application software?

Ans: _____

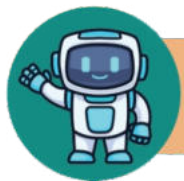
5. What do you know about a device driver?

Ans: _____

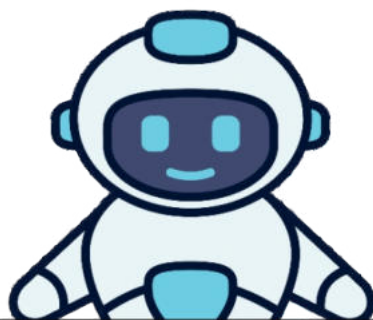


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LAB ACTIVITY



Go to your computer lab and practise opening and closing different application software like MS Paint and MS Word.

TEACHER'S NOTE

Enhance the student's knowledge about software and its types.